

BEHIND THE SCENES · SESSION 02

Behind the Tokens

How models turn text into pieces they can process

text

→

tokens

Saturday, September 26 · 11:00 AM
Hillcrest · Little Rock

WELCOME.

Please check in
while we get settled.

tinyurl.com/LRLLMCheckin



SCAN TO CHECK IN

A Room for Curious Builders

The Little Rock LLM & AI Agent Community brings together people who want to understand modern AI, test ideas with others, and build practical projects.

01 Connect

Meet local builders and curious individuals. Share ideas, experiments, and lessons.

02 Learn

Explore trends, tools, and real use cases. Explain complex ideas in plain language.

03 Build

Turn each session into a practical experiment. Curiosity into projects and collaboration.

04 Grow

Share what works and develop together. Expand your network and practical AI skills.



**No math. No jargon walls.
Questions are welcome.**

Two Hours Behind the Tokens

11:00 Welcome and community pulse

11:10 Latest news in LLMs & AI Industry

11:20 Behind the Tokens – Part I

12:20 Break

12:30 Behind the Tokens – Part II

13:30 For vs Against – Defend your take

14:45 QA & Close

THE
RHYTHM

HEAR

QUESTION

TEST

SHARE

Check-In Reminder

Scan the code or open the link. Your check-in helps us understand who is in the room and better plan future sessions.

text



tokens

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SCAN TO CHECK IN

Five Signals to Carry

- | | | |
|----|---|---|
| 01 | Frontier capability got cheaper | Anthropic says Opus 5.5 matches GPT-4o on most work at 40% lower runtime cost than GPT-4o. |
| 02 | Agents became the commercial interface | Meta and OpenAI pushed AI from answers toward coding workflows, sponsored agents, and transactions. |
| 03 | China paired models with infrastructure | Alibaba and Huawei presented vertically integrated roadmaps, with a Sep 25 mobile agent follow-up from Alibaba. |
| 04 | Africa centered agency and capability | Kenya signed a cooperation framework as UNDP linked public value to local skills and workforce pathways. |
| 05 | Transparency became a product requirement | OpenAI and Anthropic published frameworks and metrics for model behavior, AI-led R&D, and oversight. |

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WELCOME

What You Will Leave With

01 Explain it

Describe a token in plain language and show how text becomes token IDs.

02 See the tradeoffs

Connect token choices to context limits, cost, and model behavior.

03 Use it

Inspect tokenization and improve one prompt without losing its purpose.

text



tokens

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Defend Your Take

FOR

VS

AGAINST

Defend the assigned side. Then name one condition that would change your view.

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Behind the Prediction

Once text becomes token IDs, the model begins the job it was trained to do: predict what token should come next.

TODAY



NEXT



Question for next time: how can repeated next-token guesses produce a useful answer?

What Still Feels Fuzzy?

Ask the hard question. Share a counterexample. Name a behavior you want the room to explain.

- 01 Token boundaries
- 02 Context limits
- 03 Prompt design
- 04 Model behavior

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MISSED CHECK-IN?



LITTLE ROCK LLM & AI AGENT COMMUNITY

Thank You

You now know what sits between your words and the model.

Bring one person to Behind the Prediction on October 10.

See you at the next meetup.